

Student Guide — senior / module-08- yoga

IKS Curriculum

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Student Workbook

Student Workbook — Module 8 Yoga (Senior)

Name: _____ Class: ____ Section: ____

Day 1 — Three Definitions

Source	Sanskrit	English
Patañjali (YS 1.2)	<i>yogaś citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ</i>	settling of the fluctuations of consciousness
Bhagavad-gītā (2.50)	<i>yogaḥ karmasu kauśalam</i>	skill in action
Modern postural	—	physical postures + breath techniques

My current favourite definition: _____

Day 2 — Eight Limbs

(Write all 8 in Sanskrit with English.)

Of Patañjali's ~196 sūtras, ____ are devoted to āsana.

Day 3 — YS 2.46

sthira-sukham āsanam

Word-by-word: - *sthira* = _____ - *sukham* = _____ - *āsanam*
= _____

Activity ratings: | Pose | Sthira (1–5) | Sukha (1–5) | Both? | |——|——|——|——| |
Tādāsana |||| Vṛkṣāsana |||| Balāsana ||||

Day 4 — Sūrya Namaskāra

Historical note: codified in modern 12-pose form by _____ in _____ (year).

After 2 rounds with breath, my breath felt: _____

Day 5 — YS 2.49–50 + SB 4.8.44

YS 2.49 in my own words: _____

YS 2.50's three components: outer, inner, _____

SB 4.8.44 keyword: *śanair* (= _____ — meaning?)

Day 6 — Polyvagal

Three tiers: 1. Ventral vagal — _____ 2. Sympathetic — _____
3. Dorsal vagal — _____

One critique of polyvagal theory: _____

Day 7 — Modern Postural Yoga

Singleton's central thesis (in 1 sentence): _____

My reaction: [diminishes / enriches / academic attack]

Why: _____

Days 8–9 — Paper

Topic: _____

Thesis paragraph: _____

3 sources: 1. Classical: _____ 2. Historical
scholarly: _____ 3. Modern research:

Counter-argument I'll address: _____

Day 10 — Reflection

1. Topic chosen + why: _____
2. Most challenging part: _____
3. With 3 more days, deeper research on:

Glossary

Sanskrit	Meaning
yoga	union; settling the mind
citta-vṛtti-nirodha	settling of consciousness fluctuations
āsana	posture
prāṇāyāma	breath regulation
sthira-sukham	steady-and-comfortable
prayatna-śaithilya	relaxation of effort
ananta-samāpatti	absorption into the infinite
aṣṭāṅga	eight-limbed
yama, niyama	restraints, observances
pratyāhāra	sense-withdrawal
dhāraṇā, dhyāna, samādhi	focus, meditation, absorption
Patañjali	author of Yoga Sūtras

Day 1 — Three Definitions of Yoga

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min (10 min movement)

Learning objective

Students articulate three distinct definitions of *yoga* (Patañjali, Bhagavad-gītā, modern) and recognise their non-equivalence.

Materials

- Mats
- Printed: YS 1.2, BG 2.50, BG 6.10–13

Flow

Settle (3 min)

Sukhāsana. 5 breaths.

Core (15 min) — three definitions

1. **Patañjali (Yoga Sūtra 1.2):** > *yogaś citta-vṛtti-nirodhaḥ* > “Yoga is the settling of the fluctuations of consciousness.”
 - This is about the *mind*. Patañjali frames yoga as a discipline aimed at quieting mental activity.
2. **Bhagavad-gītā (2.50):** > *yogaḥ karmasu kauśalam* > “Yoga is skill in action.”
 - This is about *action*. Krishna frames yoga as a way of acting without attachment to results.
3. **Modern postural yoga (any contemporary text):** > Yoga is a system of physical postures and breath techniques for health, flexibility, and stress reduction.
 - This is about the *body*. The modern frame is the one most people in 2026 encounter first.
4. **Are these the same?** Open question. Discuss:
 - Patañjali’s eight limbs include āsana (#3) but most limbs are mental/ethical.
 - The Gītā’s “skill in action” can be done without any āsana at all.
 - Modern postural yoga focuses on what classical Patañjali treated as one *limb*, not the whole.

Practice (12 min) — tādāsana + brief vṛkṣāsana

- 3 holds of tādāsana (30 sec each).
- 2 holds vṛkṣāsana per side.
- Settle in sukhāsana for 60 sec.

Discussion (10 min)

- “Which of the three definitions feels most accurate to YOUR experience of yoga?”
- “Are they compatible? Do they conflict?”

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Preview Day 2: eight limbs in their classical Sāṅkhya-Yoga context.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read Bryant’s introduction to the *Yoga Sūtras* before Day 2. Bring 1 question.
- **Tier down:** Focus on memorising the two Sanskrit definitions (YS 1.2 and BG 2.50).

Teacher notes

- Some students will resist the framing “modern postural yoga is recent.” Save the deep history for Day 7; today just plant the three definitions.

Citation(s) used

- YS 1.2 — Bryant (2009)
- BG 2.50 — multiple translations
- vidya-karana RAG cache day-01-hook.json provides supporting BG and SB references

Day 2 — The Eight Limbs in Their Classical Context

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min (10 min movement)

Learning objective

Students enumerate the eight limbs with Patañjali’s classical definitions and locate the limbs within the Sāṅkhya-Yoga framework.

Materials

- Mats
- Eight-limbs wall chart
- YS 2.29 + 2.30, 2.32, 2.46, 2.49, 3.1, 3.2, 3.3 (key sūtras for each limb)

Flow

Settle (3 min)

Core (20 min)

1. **Read YS 2.29:** > *yama-niyamāsana-prāṇāyāma-pratyāhāra-dhāraṇā-dhyāna-samādhayo ’ṣṭāv aṅgāni* > “Restraints, observances, posture, breath regulation, sense-withdrawal, focused attention, sustained meditation, absorption — these are the eight limbs.”
2. **Walk through each limb with its key sūtra:**

#	Limb	Sanskrit gloss	Source verse
1	<i>yama</i>	restraints (ahiṃsā, satya, asteya, brahmacarya, aparigraha)	YS 2.30
2	<i>niyama</i>	observances (śauca, santoṣa, tapas,	YS 2.32

#	Limb	Sanskrit gloss	Source verse
		svādhyāya, īśvara-praṇidhāna)	
3	<i>āsana</i>	“sthira-sukham” — steady and comfortable	YS 2.46
4	<i>prāṇāyāma</i>	breath regulation; cessation of gati	YS 2.49
5	<i>pratyāhāra</i>	sense-withdrawal	YS 2.54
6	<i>dhāraṇā</i>	focused attention	YS 3.1
7	<i>dhyāna</i>	sustained meditation	YS 3.2
8	<i>samādhi</i>	absorption	YS 3.3

3. **Note the proportions.** Patañjali’s *Yoga Sūtras* total ~196 sūtras across 4 chapters. Of these:

- Ethics + observances (yama, niyama): ~16 sūtras
- Āsana: ~3 sūtras (just YS 2.46–48)
- Prāṇāyāma: ~5 sūtras (YS 2.49–53)
- Pratyāhāra: ~2 sūtras
- Dhāraṇā + dhyāna + samādhi: most of Chapter 3 (~50 sūtras)

Modern postural yoga focuses on āsana — to which Patañjali devotes 3 sūtras out of 196.

Practice (12 min)

- Tāḍāsana → vṛkṣāsana → baddha-koṇāsana → balāsana → sukhāsana.

Limb quiz (5 min)

- 8 marks — name all 8 limbs in Sanskrit with English meaning.

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Preview Day 3: “Tomorrow we read YS 2.46 closely — Patañjali’s definition of āsana.”

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Memorise the 5 *yamas* and 5 *niyamas* in Sanskrit.
- **Tier down:** Memorise the 8 limbs only.

Teacher notes

- The “proportions” observation is a powerful teaching moment. Most students assume yoga = āsana. The 3-out-of-196 statistic reframes this.

Citation(s) used

- Patañjali YS 2.29, 2.30, 2.32, 2.46, 2.49 — Bryant (2009).
- vidya-karana RAG cache day-02-eightlimbs.json.

Day 3 — Āsana: Patañjali's Definition (YS 2.46)

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min (15 min movement)

Learning objective

Students read YS 2.46–48 in IAST + translation, identify the dual condition for āsana (steady AND comfortable), and reflect on whether modern āsana practice meets Patañjali's criterion.

Materials

- Mats
- Printed YS 2.46–48 with Bryant's commentary
- Practice space

Flow

Settle (3 min)

Reading (15 min)

1. **YS 2.46:** > *sthira-sukham āsanam* > “Posture should be steady and comfortable.”
 - 3 words. 3 Sanskrit words. *sthira* = steady, firm. *sukha* = comfortable, easeful. *āsanam* = posture.
 - The dual condition: BOTH steady AND comfortable. Not steady-but-uncomfortable. Not comfortable-but-collapsing.
2. **YS 2.47:** > *prayatna-śaithilyānanta-samāpattibhyām* > “[Sthira-sukham is achieved] through the relaxation of effort and absorption into the infinite.”
 - Two means to the dual condition: *prayatna-śaithilya* (relaxing effort) and *ananta-samāpatti* (absorption into the infinite / the limitless).
3. **YS 2.48:** > *tato dvandvānabhighātaḥ* > “Then [the practitioner is] no longer afflicted by the pairs of opposites.”
 - Result: equanimity in the face of dualities (hot/cold, comfort/discomfort, etc.).

Practice (15 min) — Test the definition

Hold tādāsana for 60 sec. Notice: - Are you *sthira* (steady)? - Are you *sukha* (comfortable)? - Are you both?

Now hold vṛkṣāsana (right). Same questions.

Then balāsana for 90 sec. Same questions.

Discussion (in pairs, 2 min): which pose best met Patañjali's dual criterion for you, today?

Reflection writing (8 min)

5-minute quick-write: “Does modern postural yoga, with its emphasis on advanced and challenging poses, actually meet Patañjali’s criterion of steady AND comfortable? Argue your position in 4–5 sentences.”

Wrap-up (4 min)

- 2 students share their position.
- Preview Day 4: “Tomorrow — Sūrya Namaskāra. And a surprising historical question about its age.”

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read Bryant’s full commentary on YS 2.46–48. Bring 1 question.
- **Tier down:** Focus on memorising YS 2.46 in Sanskrit (3 words).

Teacher notes

- The dual criterion is genuinely counter-cultural to most modern yoga. Many studios push the “challenging hold” model. Patañjali doesn’t.
- The reflection writing often surfaces students’ own conflicted relationship with effort vs ease.

Citation(s) used

- Patañjali YS 2.46–48 — Bryant (2009), p. 282–286.

Day 4 — Sūrya Namaskāra: Practice and Historical Note

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min (20 min movement)

Learning objective

Students perform 2 rounds of Sūrya Namaskāra with breath co-ordination AND learn the surprising historical fact that the modern sequence is early-20th-century.

Materials

- Mats
- Wall poster of 12 SN poses
- Brief printed handout on SN history (teacher synopsis, 1 page)

Flow

Settle (3 min)

Core (10 min) — The history

- Sūrya Namaskāra in its modern 12-pose form was codified by the Raja of Aundh (Bhawanrao Shrinivasrao Pant Pratinidhi) in the early 20th century. He published *The Ten-Point Way to Health* in 1928, popularising the sequence.
- The individual āsanās have older roots. The sequence does not.
- This is one of many examples where modern postural yoga has a 20th-century pedigree, even when the Sanskrit names sound ancient.
- (We return to this on Day 7.)

Practice (20 min) — 2 rounds with breath

#	Pose	Breath
1	Praṇāmāsana	exhale
2	Hasta-uttānāsana	inhale
3	Uttānāsana	exhale
4	Aśva-saṅcalanāsana	inhale
5	Adho-mukha-śvānāsana	exhale
6	Aṣṭāṅga-namaskāra	(brief hold)
7	Bhujāṅgāsana	inhale
8	Adho-mukha-śvānāsana	exhale
9	Aśva-saṅcalanāsana	inhale
10	Uttānāsana	exhale
11	Hasta-uttānāsana	inhale
12	Praṇāmāsana	exhale

Round 1: slow, teacher-called. Round 2: at your own pace, breath-led.

Śavāsana for 2 min after.

Discussion (8 min)

- Did knowing the modern history change how the practice felt? Why or why not?
- Patañjali's *sthira-sukham* criterion — does Sūrya Namaskāra meet it?

Wrap-up (4 min)

- Preview Day 5: “Tomorrow — primary source reading on prāṇāyāma.”

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read about the Krishnamacharya lineage (Singleton ch. 8 brief).
- **Tier down:** 1 round at slower pace; focus on breath co-ordination.

Teacher notes

- The history surprises students. Some find it diminishing; others find it interesting. Both reactions are legitimate.
- Inversions in advanced SN variations are *not* taught here. Stick to the basic 12-pose sequence.

Citation(s) used

- Pant Pratinidhi (1928). *The Ten-Point Way to Health*.
- Singleton (2010). *Yoga Body*, ch. on SN.

Day 5 — Prāṇāyāma + Primary Source Reading

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min (15 min movement / breath)

Learning objective

Students read YS 2.49–50 in IAST + translation, practise counted breath safely, and complete the formative quiz.

Materials

- Mats
- Printed YS 2.49–50 with translation + commentary
- Printed SB 4.8.44 (from cache)
- Formative quiz Part B

Flow

Settle (3 min)

Primary source reading (12 min)

1. **YS 2.49:** > *tasmin sati śvāsa-praśvāsayor gati-vicchedaḥ prāṇāyāmaḥ* > “When that [āsa] is established, prāṇāyāma is the regulation [literally: severing of the flow] of inhalation and exhalation.”
 - Note: prāṇāyāma presupposes āsana. You don’t do prāṇāyāma in chaotic posture.
2. **YS 2.50:** > *bāhya-ābhyantara-stambha-vṛttir deśa-kāla-saṅkhyābhiḥ paridṛṣṭo dīrgha-sūkṣmaḥ* > “Prāṇāyāma has three modifications: outer (exhale), inner (inhale), and held (retained). It is observed by place, time, and number, and becomes long and subtle.”
 - Three components: out-breath, in-breath, retention. Three measurements: place (in body), time (duration), number (count).
 - The goal: *dīrgha-sūkṣma* — long and subtle.
3. **SB 4.8.44:** > *prāṇāyāmena tṛ-vṛtā prāṇendriya-mano-malam śanair vyudasyābhidyāyen manasā guruṇā gurum* > “Through the threefold prāṇāyāma practice, one gradually purifies the breath, senses, and mind, and meditates.”

Practice (12 min) — Safe counted breath

- 5 min: natural-breath observation.
- 5 min: counted breath (4 in, 4 out). No retention.
- 2 min: śavāsana.

Senior-band caveat: With explicit teacher screening for contraindications (asthma, anxiety disorders), counted breath with brief retention (4-4-4-4: in 4, hold 4, out 4, hold 4) MAY be introduced. Default: skip retention.

Formative quiz Part B (15 min)

- 10 marks: limb identification, YS verse identification, safety question, short answer on YS 2.46 dual criterion, primary source reading question.

Wrap-up (3 min)

- Preview Day 6: “*Tomorrow — the modern research framing. Polyvagal theory.*”

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read Bryant’s commentary on YS 2.49–53. Note Vyāsa’s framing of subtler prāṇāyāma practices.
- **Tier down:** Stay with the natural breath; the YS verses can be re-read at home.

Teacher notes

- The “ascending from gross to subtle” arc of YS 2.49 → 2.50 → 2.51 is one of the most concise descriptions of prāṇāyāma in any tradition. Linger here.
- For safety: forceful prāṇāyāma is genuinely contraindicated for several conditions. Default position: natural breath + counted breath only.

Citation(s) used

- Patañjali YS 2.49–50 — Bryant (2009), p. 288–292.
- SB 4.8.44 — vidya-karana RAG cache day-06-pranayama.json.

Day 6 — Polyvagal Theory + Yoga

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min (10 min movement)

Learning objective

Students read Porges (2009) and articulate the polyvagal-theory framing of how yoga practices affect the autonomic nervous system.

Materials

- Mats
- Printed Porges (2009) or teacher synopsis (1–2 pages)
- Diagram of three-tier ANS (ventral vagal / sympathetic / dorsal vagal)

Flow

Settle (3 min)

Reading (15 min)

- Silent read of Porges (2009) extract.
- As they read, students note:
 - The three-tier ANS framework
 - What “ventral vagal” / “sympathetic” / “dorsal vagal” mean operationally
 - How yoga practices (specifically breath + posture + interoception) might engage the ventral vagal complex
 - One question they have

Core discussion (15 min)

1. Build the three-tier picture on the board:

Tier	State	Behaviour	Heart rate
Ventral vagal	Safe, social, connected	Calm engagement	Slow, variable (high HRV)
Sympathetic	Mobilised, alert	Fight or flight	Fast, low HRV
Dorsal vagal	Shutdown, conservation	Freeze, dissociation	Very slow

2. Yoga’s hypothesised effects (per Porges and others):

- Slow exhalation → ventral vagal activation.
- Steady āsana practice → interoceptive awareness → ventral vagal.
- Group yoga practice → social engagement → ventral vagal.

3. Limits and critiques.

- Porges’s theory has critics — Grossman & Taylor (2007) and others dispute specific claims about vagal physiology.
- The cleanest claim that survives: slow exhalation IS associated with parasympathetic activation (whether or not the polyvagal three-tier model is fully correct).

Practice (8 min) — Test the theory

- 1 min sukhāsana, natural breath, count heart rate (carotid pulse if comfortable).
- 5 min counted breath (4 in, 4 out).
- 1 min sukhāsana, count heart rate again.

Did anything change? (Most students notice a slight slowing. The N=1 anecdote doesn’t prove anything, but it lets students *feel* the principle.)

Wrap-up (4 min)

- 2 students share their question from the reading.
- Preview Day 7: “*Tomorrow — modern postural yoga’s specific 20th-century lineage.*”

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read the Grossman & Taylor (2007) critique. Bring 1 specific objection to discuss.
- **Tier down:** Focus on the three-tier ANS framework; the polyvagal extensions can be supplementary.

Teacher notes

- The polyvagal framework is currently popular in wellness circles. It is *defensible* but not *settled*. Help students engage it as one framework, not as proof.

Citation(s) used

- Porges, S. W. (2009). “The polyvagal theory.” *Cleveland Clinic Journal of Medicine*.
- (Optional) Grossman & Taylor (2007). *Biological Psychology*.

Day 7 — Modern Postural Yoga: A Historical Note

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min (10 min movement)

Learning objective

Students engage Singleton’s (2010) thesis that modern postural yoga is largely a 20th-century synthesis, articulate one strength and one weakness of that thesis, and discuss what is at stake.

Materials

- Mats
- Printed extract from Singleton (2010), *Yoga Body* — Introduction + Ch. 1 (or teacher synopsis)
- Whiteboard

Flow

Settle (3 min)

Core (20 min)

1. **Singleton’s thesis** (write on board): > Modern postural yoga, as taught in studios and schools worldwide today, is largely a 20th-century synthesis — drawing on classical Indian texts AND on European physical-culture movements that arrived in India during the colonial period (gymnastics, Swedish drill, bodybuilding, etc.).
2. **Specific examples Singleton gives:**

- Sūrya Namaskāra in its modern form: early 20th c. (Raja of Aundh, 1928).
- The strong-postural emphasis: Krishnamacharya (1888–1989), in Mysore Palace.
- The flow + breath co-ordination: 20th-c. innovation, partly inspired by Western physical culture.
- The international spread: Krishnamacharya’s students Iyengar (1918–2014), Pattabhi Jois (1915–2009), Desikachar (1938–2016), TKV’s daughter Indra Devi.

3. What Singleton does NOT claim:

- Singleton does NOT say “yoga is fake.”
- Singleton does NOT say “Patañjali is recent.”
- Singleton does NOT say “Indians didn’t invent yoga.”
- Singleton says: *the modern postural form is recent, even though many of its component techniques are old.*

4. Why this matters:

- For students: avoids the trap of either uncritical reverence or dismissive “it’s all made-up.”
- For policy: NEP §4.6 (“Integration of IKS”) works best when IKS is presented accurately, including the modern history.
- For practice: knowing the history doesn’t diminish the value. Modern postural yoga *works* — that’s not in dispute.

Discussion (15 min)

- “What is *YOUR* reaction to Singleton’s thesis? Does it diminish yoga, enrich your understanding, or feel like Western academic attack?”
- Hear from multiple students. Don’t resolve the question.
- Add: “Singleton is a British scholar. Does that matter? Why or why not?”

Practice (5 min)

Brief Sūrya Namaskāra — 1 round. Same body, fresh awareness.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- Preview Day 8: “Tomorrow — paper outlining.”

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Read De Michelis (2004) too. Compare and contrast with Singleton.
- **Tier down:** Focus on Singleton’s central thesis; the further reading can wait.

Teacher notes

- This is the most politically loaded session of the module. Honour the discomfort some students will feel.
- The honest framing: *cultural achievements are not less valuable for being recent. Modern postural yoga is also a real Indian achievement; it’s just a 20th-century one rather than an ancient one.*

Citation(s) used

- Singleton, M. (2010). *Yoga Body: The Origins of Modern Posture Practice*. Oxford University Press.
- De Michelis, E. (2004). *A History of Modern Yoga*. (Optional further reading.)

Day 8 — Project Session 1: Topic + Outline

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students commit to a research-synthesis paper topic, draft a thesis paragraph, and produce an outline citing all 3 required source types.

Materials

- Project brief + rubric
- Drafting materials

Flow

Warm-up (5 min)

Topic selection (15 min)

Suggested topics: - “Does the counted-breath prāṇāyāma practice we learned have measurable effects on HRV? A literature review.” - “Patañjali defines āsana as ‘steady and comfortable’ (YS 2.46). Does modern postural yoga meet this criterion? Examine through 3 specific postures.” - “Singleton (2010) argues modern postural yoga is largely 20th century. Evaluate his evidence.” - “Compare Patañjali’s prāṇāyāma framework (YS 2.49–53) with the polyvagal theory’s account of breath effects.” - “Choose any one āsana and trace its history from classical text (if any) to modern practice. What does the history reveal?”

Each student commits to a topic. Discusses with teacher (60-sec rotation) — too broad? too narrow?

Outline (20 min)

Standard 5-6 page outline: - Intro with thesis - 3 body sections - Counter-argument - Conclusion - Works cited (3+ sources, must include 1 classical primary + 1 historical scholarly + 1 modern research)

Wrap-up (5 min)

- Outline submitted at door.

Homework

- Begin drafting at home.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Add a 4th source type (e.g. an empirical study of an unrelated culture's somatic practice).
- **Tier down:** Narrow your topic further; one specific verse + one specific modern study is enough depth.

Teacher notes

- Strong topics are specific. Weak topics are broad. Push for specificity.

Day 9 — Project Session 2: Draft + Counter

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Each student reaches at least 2 pages drafted including a counter-argument and response.

Materials

- Drafts in progress

Flow

Warm-up (3 min)

- Brief: today's focus is the counter-argument.

Sprints (35 min)

- 15 min draft body
- 15 min buddy counter-argument workshop (cross-topic pairings recommended)
- 5 min incorporate

Wrap-up (7 min)

- 3 students share their best counter.

Homework

- Finish draft. Bring tomorrow.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Two distinct counters from different angles.
- **Tier down:** Detailed outline + 1 paragraph acceptable if a full draft is too much.

Teacher notes

- Common pattern: students avoid the counter because it feels like weakening their thesis. Reframe — a strong paper anticipates objections.

Day 10 — Summative + Paper Submission

Module: Yoga (Senior) · **Time:** 45 min

Learning objective

Students complete summative quiz and submit 5–6 page research-synthesis paper.

Materials

- Summative quiz
- Stopwatch

Flow

Quiz (35 min)

- 35 marks. MC, limb identification, primary-source reading, safety question, polyvagal-theory question, open response.

Paper submission (8 min)

- Print or upload. Teacher spot-checks.

Wrap-up (2 min)

- Reflection slip.
- Closing namaste.

Homework

- None. Module complete.

Differentiation

- **Tier up:** Begin reading next module's prerequisites.
- **Tier down:** Open-notebook quiz for documented learning needs.

Teacher notes

- Mark within 5 days.
- Research papers should be assessed on quality of synthesis, not on agreement with any particular position.

Writing Prompts

Writing Prompts — Module 8 Yoga (Senior)

Reflection

1. **(Day 1)** Before this module, what did “yoga” mean to you? Which of the three definitions (Patañjali / Gītā / modern) most matched your assumption?
2. **(Day 3)** Does YOUR yoga practice meet Patañjali’s *sthira-sukham* criterion? Be honest.

Explanatory

3. **(Day 5)** Explain what YS 2.49 says about the relationship between āsana and prāṇāyāma in 5 sentences.
4. **(Day 6)** Explain polyvagal theory to a Grade 9 reader in 1 page.

Argumentative

5. **(Day 7)** Argue: “Singleton’s (2010) historical thesis enriches rather than diminishes yoga practice.” 1–2 pages.
6. **(Day 7)** Argue the OPPOSITE: “Singleton’s framing is a Western-academic project that doesn’t change what yoga IS for the practitioner.”

Cross-disciplinary

7. **(Stretch)** Compare Patañjali’s *sthira-sukham* with a similar dual condition from another tradition (Japanese *seiza* meditation? Christian centering prayer?). What’s the philosophical move both make?
 8. **(Stretch)** Read a contemporary peer-reviewed study on yoga’s effects (Pascoe 2017 meta-analysis recommended). Critique the methodology in 1 page.
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Grading

Same as Module 2/5 Senior — thesis, citations, counter-argument, prose.

Homework

Homework — Module 8 (Senior)

Night	Task	Time
Day 1 → 2	Read Bryant’s intro to <i>Yoga</i>	25 min

Night	Task	Time
	<i>Sūtras</i> . Note 1 question.	
Day 2 → 3	Memorise the 8 limbs in Sanskrit.	15 min
Day 3 → 4	Practise tādāsana + vṛkṣāsana + balāsana. Reflect: <i>sthira-sukham</i> ?	15 min
Day 4 → 5	Read YS 2.49–53 in Bryant’s translation.	25 min
Day 5 → 6	Prepare for Porges reading; read teacher-prepared synopsis.	15 min
Day 6 → 7	Read Singleton’s intro to <i>Yoga Body</i> .	30 min
Day 7 → 8	Submit project plan: topic + thesis + 3 sources.	30 min
Day 8 → 9	Draft 1.5–2 pages.	60–90 min
Day 9 → 10	Complete draft, format, citations.	60–90 min